

The Ethical Operator Portfolio: Building a Sustainable, Reliable & Client-Ready Business System

Deliverable 1: Role Model & Operating Principles

- **Selected Leader:** Shreyas Doshi (Product Leader & Corporate Advisor).
- **Leadership Behaviour 1:** Refuses to commit to vague project scopes without explicit definition of target outcomes.
 - *My Operating Rule:* I will never begin execution or accept payment until an explicit Scope of Work (SOW) with defined completion criteria is signed.
- **Leadership Behaviour 2:** Mandates transparent, proactive communication regarding delays rather than hiding bad news.
 - *My Operating Rule:* I inform clients of schedule variances at least 48 hours prior to milestone deadlines, accompanied by a revised timeline.
- **Leadership Behaviour 3:** Declines misaligned engagements that risk burnout or quality degradation.
 - *My Operating Rule:* I cap active client work at 3 concurrent major projects to safeguard delivery standards and professional health.

Deliverable 2: Brief Decoding Worksheet (\$3,000 Project Risk Analysis)

- **Unclear Scope & Deliverables:**
 - No defined count for screens, user flows, or design iterations.
 - Missing technical handoff specifications (e.g., Figma design tokens, responsive breakpoints).
- **Risky Assumptions:**
 - Assuming the client will provide complete branding assets and user requirements promptly.
 - Assuming the deadline accommodates current client commitments without stress-testing.
- **Financial Risks:**
 - Absence of upfront deposit exposes 100% of labor costs to non-payment or project cancellation.
 - Uncapped revisions reduce the effective hourly rate, eroding profit margins.
- **Operational Risks:**
 - Unbounded availability expectations trigger burnout and client dissatisfaction.
 - Rush delivery without systematic quality assurance threatens professional reputation.



Deliverable 3: Discovery & Communication Design

Discovery Call Question Framework

- **Outcomes:** *"What specific conversion or engagement metrics define success for this UI/UX redesign?"*
- **Constraints:** *"Are there fixed investor demos or product launch dates tied to this deadline?"*
- **Process:** *"Who holds final sign-off authority, and what is your internal review timeline for deliverables?"*
- **History:** *"What previous design bottlenecks or agency experiences inform your expectations for this project?"*

Client Clarification Email

Subject: Next Steps: \$3,000 Design Project Scope & Alignment

Hi [Client Name],

Thank you for reaching out regarding the UI/UX design project. I am excited about the prospect of partnering with your team.

To ensure we achieve your business targets within a realistic timeframe, I require a structured alignment call prior to issuing a formal proposal. Could we schedule a 20-minute discovery session this Thursday at 2:00 PM WAT?

Please complete this brief 3-minute intake form prior to our call: [Link to Intake Form].

Looking forward to our conversation.

Best regards,

Gboh-Igbara D. Charles

Lead Product Designer

Client Intake Form Template

- Target product objectives and key user pain points.
- Existing design assets, brand guidelines, and target user personas.
- Primary contact point and designated sign-off authority.

Deliverable 4: Scope of Work (SOW) Document

- **Project Objectives:** Redesign the primary onboarding flow and user dashboard for web/mobile applications to streamline sign-ups and reduce user drop-off.
- **Deliverables:**
 1. Interactive Figma wireframes (low-fidelity) covering 3 primary user flows.



- 2. High-fidelity UI designs (up to 12 core screens) in light/dark modes.
- 3. Interactive Figma prototype for usability validation.
- 4. Developer handoff documentation including component library and style tokens.
- **Realistic Timeline:** 4-week execution cycle (Week 1: Research & Wireframes; Week 2–3: High-Fidelity UI & Prototype; Week 4: Testing & Handoff). Includes a built-in 3-day contingency buffer.
- **Revision Limits:** Includes up to 2 revision rounds per phase. Subsequent revisions billed at ₦25,000/hour under a signed Change Order.
- **Assumptions:** Client provides brand assets and feedback within 48 hours of submission.
- **Payment Structure:** Total fee \$3,000 USD (or NGN equivalent). 40% deposit upon signing, 30% upon wireframe approval, 30% upon final handoff.

Deliverable 5: Payment & Risk Protection System

- **Deposit Requirement:** Minimum 40% upfront deposit required prior to work placement on the calendar.
- **Milestone Billing:** Payments tied strictly to deliverable approvals (Deposit / Midpoint / Final). Assets released only upon receipt of cleared funds.
- **Late Payment Clause:** 5-day grace period post-invoice maturity. Overdue balances incur a 1.5% weekly late fee; active work pauses on Day 7 overdue.
- **Scope Creep Policy:** Out-of-scope requests trigger a formal Change Order detailing adjusted costs and revised delivery dates.
- **Cancellation Policy:** Written notice required. Upfront deposit is non-refundable; client receives completed work up to the last paid milestone.

Deliverable 6: Consistency & Delivery System

Weekly Status Update Template

Subject: [Project Name] — Weekly Status Update (Week [X])

Completed This Week:

- Finalized low-fidelity wireframes for onboarding flows.
- Conducted internal design review for accessibility compliance.

In Progress:

- Developing high-fidelity UI screens for the main dashboard.
- Preparing interactive Figma prototype.



Awaiting Action From You:

- Written approval on Phase 1 wireframes (Due: Friday by 5:00 PM).

Next Milestone: High-fidelity UI review scheduled for [Date].

Deliverable 7: Financial & Decision Risk Analysis

● Scenario A — Accepting As-Is (Unstructured):

- Gross Revenue: \$3,000.
- Estimated Rework & Scope Creep Hours: 40 additional hours.
- Effective Hourly Rate Drops: From \$50/hr (60 hrs) to \$30/hr (100 hrs).
- Risk Factor: High likelihood of delayed final payment, zero upfront safety net, capacity conflict with existing \$5,000/mo retainer load.

Scenario B — Renegotiating with Structure (Recommended):

- Gross Revenue: \$3,000.
- Payment Protection: \$1,200 secured upfront (40%).
- Execution Time Capped: 50 focused hours supported by 2 revision limits.
- Effective Hourly Rate: \$60/hr.
- Risk Factor: Low; preserves operational baseline and builds sustainable client relationship.

Scenario C — Declining Project:

- Opportunity Cost Saved: 60 hours redirected to existing high-value client retainers or system optimization.

Deliverable 8: Final Decision Statement & Justification

● Final Decision: RENEGOTIATE.

● Justification:

1. *Systems Realism:* Accepting the offer without defined boundaries undermines the Scope of Work and Risk Protection frameworks. Presenting a structured SOW and 40% deposit model establishes clear boundaries while maintaining client trust.
2. *Financial Logic:* The risk analysis demonstrates that an unnegotiated \$3,000 project reduces profitability due to scope creep and unpaid revisions. Structuring payment terms guarantees \$1,200 upfront and preserves effective hourly rates.



3. *Long-Term Sustainability*: Renegotiating positions the business as an ethical operator rather than a reactive contractor, protecting time, deliverable quality, and capacity. If the client rejects these professional terms, the project will be formally declined.

